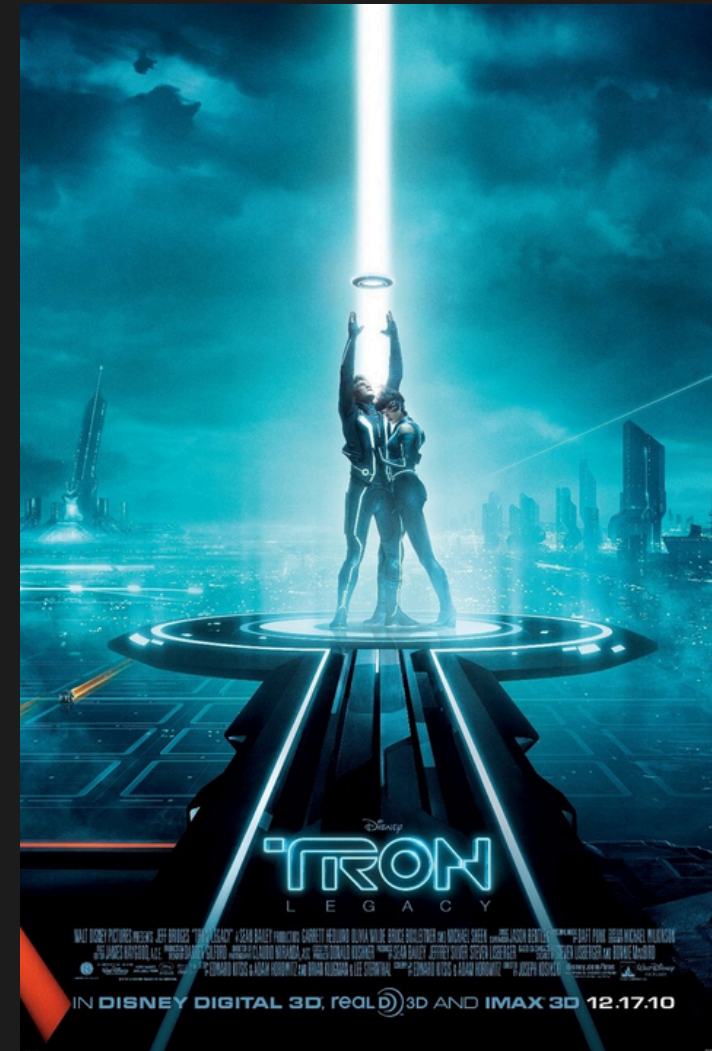


THE LEGACY SEQUEL FORMULA



LOLA HERTSENBERG

THE BEST & WORST SEQUELS

BUSINESS INSIDER, "14 OF THE BEST LEGACY SEQUELS — AND 7 OF THE WORST"

Gold Standard: Top Gun: Maverick

- 36 years after the original
- \$1.5B worldwide
- Familiar characters + new cast
- New story

One of the "Worst": Practical Magic 2

- ~28 years after the original
- Sandra Bullock & Nicole Kidman
- Story returns to same place
- Doesn't capture original's appeal

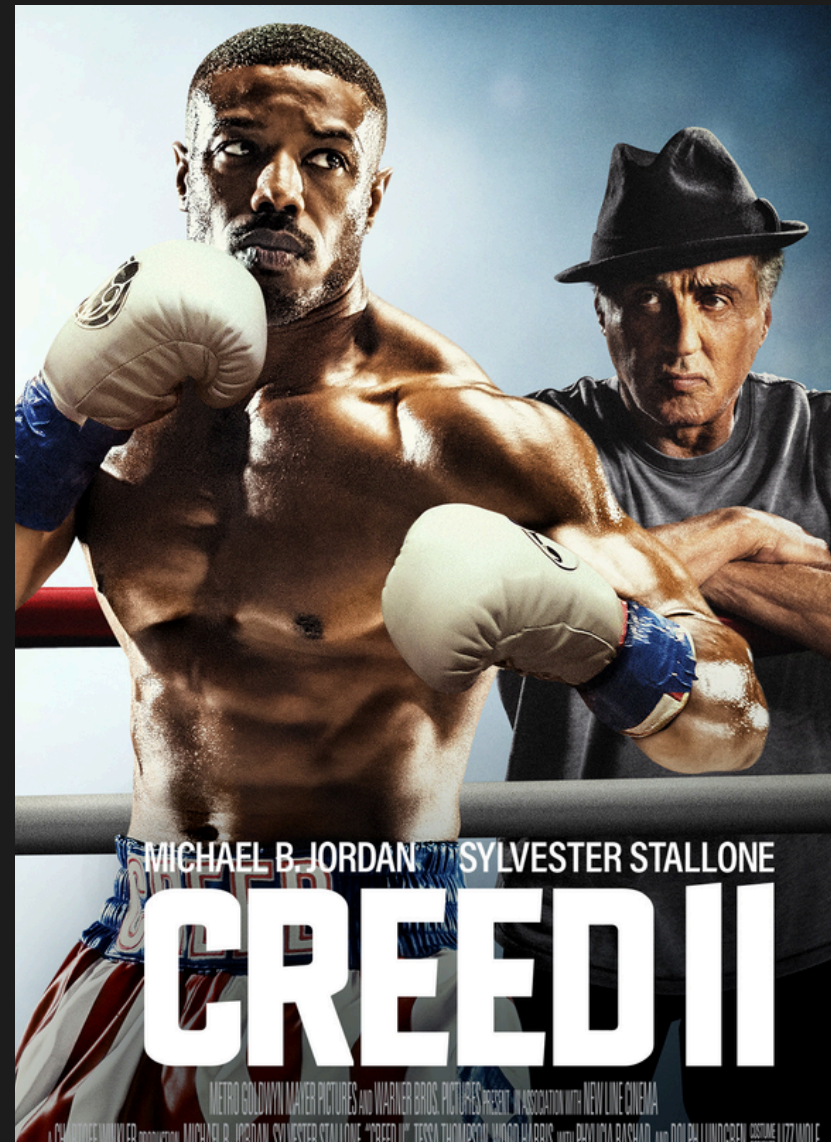
NOSTALGIA IS NOT ENOUGH

ORIGINAL CHARACTERS + NOSTALGIA + NEW STORY → NEW AUDIENCE



TOP GUN → MAVERICK

MAVERICK + ROOSTER



ROCKY → CREED

ROCKY + ADONIS



**STAR WARS → THE
FORCE AWAKENS**

ORIGINAL CAST + REY/FINN/POE

AUDIENCES WANT SOMETHING NEW

VARIETY, "DON'T CALL IT A SEQUEL. OR A REBOOT. OR A REMAKE. WHY CERTAIN WORDS TRIGGER HOLLYWOOD"



JURASSIC WORLD
VS. JURASSIC PARK 4



MAD MAX: FURY ROAD
VS. MAD MAX 4



BLADE RUNNER 2049
VS. BLADE RUNNER 2

CITATIONS

[https://www.proquest.com/docview/3388107654?
accountid=10357&parentSessionId=7VBukDsm7EZUd8OjprvD3DL0c+lbQB7RjKKZjQZSRL
g%3D&sourcetype=Newspapers](https://www.proquest.com/docview/3388107654?accountid=10357&parentSessionId=7VBukDsm7EZUd8OjprvD3DL0c+lbQB7RjKKZjQZSRLg%3D&sourcetype=Newspapers)

[https://au.variety.com/2026/film/global/movie-studios-reboot-sequel-social-
reckoning-37781/](https://au.variety.com/2026/film/global/movie-studios-reboot-sequel-social-reckoning-37781/)